

(Don't cower under a nick forever, though that's OK right in the beginning.)

- Promote equality by not restricting specific users or groups of users from your blog.

(Simple. Be “democratic,” as we've mentioned in this book.)

- Minimise harm to others by never knowingly hurting or injuring someone with information you make available on your blog.

(“First, do no harm.”)

- Build a community by linking your blog to others, and maintain a blogroll to encourage visitors to your blog to visit others and facilitate relationships between you and your readers.

(This, again, deals with being social, and the human element.)

- Strive for factual truth and never intentionally deceive readers. Make yourself accountable for information you post online.

(Remember, when you're blogging, it might seem like you're doing keystrokes at your desktop—but there are real human beings out there reading what you're writing.)

- Cite and link to all sources referenced in each blog post, and secure permission before linking to other blogs or Web content.

- Promote interactivity by posting regularly to your blog, honouring such etiquette and protocol policies that are posted on blogs you visit, and make an effort to be entertaining enough to inspire return visits to your site.

Bloggers should:

- Never plagiarise.

(Be honest to yourself and you're safe.)

- Identify and link to sources whenever feasible. The public is entitled to as much information as possible on sources' reliability.

(Similar to what we just said: you're actually reaching out!)